

Animal Risk Quick Guide

Species-by-species risks and safety tips. Post at guide briefings and the Command Post.

Animal	Key risk	Safety tips
Elephant	Charges if surprised or provoked	Stay quiet and still. Retreat slowly behind hard cover if there's space. Never block the path or a calf.
Lion / Leopard	Nocturnal stalking, close-quarters risk	Never walk alone; keep lights on; report sightings. If an encounter is imminent, back away facing the animal — don't run.
Hippo	Extremely aggressive near water	Avoid riverbanks at night; keep to designated routes; give waterways a wide berth.
Buffalo	Unpredictable, charges especially when injured	Avoid thick bush; no unguided walking in cover; use vehicles.
Snakes	Venom risk	Wear boots, always use a torch at night, avoid tall grass and woodpiles.
Crocodile	Ambush near water's edge	No swimming; stay well back from river or dam edges.
Monkey / Baboon	Aggressive when fed	Never feed; keep windows and doors closed; secure food.
Hyena	Bold, unpredictable scavenger	Do not approach; back away and stay alert.